

Mini Metro (Mind the Gap Archetype)

Game Jam Reference: Ludum Dare 26 | Dinosaur Polo Club

Core Fantasy & Player Experience

The player assumes the role of an urban transit architect. The game begins as a tranquil, zen-like design canvas featuring just a few isolated stations and soft musical chimes. However, as the procedural city grows, the network transitions into high-intensity triage. The player must continuously optimize track topology, rebalance train lines, and deploy scarce resources to prevent the subway from collapsing into catastrophic overcrowding.

Ground-Level Micro-Mechanics

- **Schematic Vector Canvas:** Inspired by Harry Beck's 1931 London Underground map—clean white space, bold geometric lines, and iconic station shapes replacing complex 3D world models.
- **Stations as Geometric Symbols:** Stations spawn procedurally as Circles (residential/suburbs), Triangles (commercial areas), and Squares (downtown work hubs). Rare shapes (Cross, Star) emerge over time.
- **Passenger Desires & Logistics:** Commuters spawn beside stations marked with their destination shape. A commuter at a Circle station marked with a [Triangle] icon seeks transit to any Triangle station on the network.
- **Click-and-Drag Track Routing:** The player clicks on any station and drags a line to another to create or extend transit lines. Trains automatically spawn and shuttle commuters along the created routes.
- **The Overcrowding Clock (Fail State):** Stations have a capacity threshold (e.g., 6 waiting passengers). If exceeded, a radial warning timer winds down. If not cleared by an arriving train in time, the station collapses—Game Over.
- **The Scarcity Economy:** Every in-game "Sunday" (or 90 seconds), players choose an upgrade grant: +1 Line Color, +1 Extra Locomotive, or +1 Carriage (doubles passenger capacity).

Godot 4 Technical Implementation (5-Day Scope)

- **Track Vectors via Line2D:** Constructed using Godot 4 Line2D nodes configured with antialiased round joint caps, or dynamic `_draw()` calls managed by a central TransitMap coordinator.
- **Train Motion via PathFollow2D:** When a route connects stations A -> B -> C, build a Curve2D. Each train is a PathFollow2D whose `progress_ratio` ping-pongs smoothly between 0.0 and 1.0.
- **Jam-Optimized Commuter Logic:** Passengers board a train only if that train's line directly contains their destination shape, or a designated interchange station, eliminating complex graph search overhead.
- **Overcrowding Alert Node:** Each Station is an Area2D holding a passenger array. If `passengers.size() > 6`, a tweened circular Line2D arc renders the countdown timer.

Titan Souls Archetype

Game Jam Reference: Ludum Dare 28 | Acid Nerve

Core Fantasy & Player Experience

Shadow of the Colossus meets Dark Souls stripped down to its absolute essence. The game discards all filler—no trash mobs, no experience grinding, no complex inventory, and no lengthy dungeons. The player is an unarmed explorer carrying a single arrow, confronting titanic mythological colossi in deadly duels that conclude in under 30 seconds: either by your death or theirs.

The "Triple-One" Rule & Combat Anatomy

- **1 Hit Point for Player:** Any damage from a boss attack, shockwave, or collision kills the player instantly. Survival depends on reflexes and positioning.
- **1 Hit Point for the Boss:** The giant colossus also dies in a single direct strike. However, its glowing weak spot is heavily armored, hidden, or exposed only during specific attack states.
- **1 Single Arrow:** The player carries no quiver. Once loosed, your sole weapon remains lodged in the ground or embedded in the arena wall.
- **The Signature "Recall" Mechanic:** Holding the Recall button magnetically pulls the arrow back to your hands in a straight vector. While recalling, you are stationary (maximum vulnerability). However, the returning arrow is lethal and can pierce the boss from behind (maximum reward)!
- **0.5-Second Instant Respawn Loop:** Death has no loading screens or menu interruptions. The screen flashes dark and immediately resets you at the arena gate, fueling an addictive "just one more try" loop.

Interactive Puzzle Bosses & Godot 4 Blueprint

- **Boss 1 — Slime Colossus:** Bounces across the arena. When hit, it splits into two smaller, faster slimes. Only one half contains the exposed crystalline heart.
- **Boss 2 — Eyeball Monolith:** Rolls along perimeter walls. Three faces are solid stone; its fourth face houses a glowing eye that opens for 1.5s only while charging a laser.
- **Boss 3 — Frost Brain:** Encased in an ice cube that deflects arrows. The player must lure it over floor braziers to melt the ice before striking the core.
- **Godot 4 Architecture:** Top-down CharacterBody2D with dodge roll i-frames. The Arrow is an Area2D with three states: STATE_FLYING (velocity), STATE_STUCK (anchored), and STATE_RETURNING (linear interpolation vector toward player). Bosses use clean GDScript finite state machines: IDLE -> WINDUP -> ATTACK -> EXPOSED_VULNERABLE -> RECOVER.